

Diego Maximiliano Macall

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Employment

ICABR Secretary-General, International Consortium on Applied Bioeconomy Research (ICABR)	2018–present
Research Assistant, Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics, University of Saskatchewan	2017–2021
English–Spanish Translator, Saskatoon Open Door Society	2018–2020
International Agricultural Intern, United States Department of Agriculture, Foreign Agricultural Service	2017–2017
Research Assistant, Ministerio de Educación de El Salvador	2013–2014

Education

Ph.D. in Environmental Science and Technology, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona	Nov 2025
M.Sc. in Agricultural Economics, University of Saskatchewan	Nov 2016
Agronomic Engineering, Catholic University of El Salvador	Nov 2012

Affiliations

Secretary General, International Consortium on Applied Bioeconomy Research (ICABR)	2022–present
Sigma Xi, The Scientific Research Honor Society	2023–present

Grants and Awards

”la Caixa” Doctoral INPhINIT Fellowship	2022–2025
GIZ Essay Contest Winner, COFOCA VII participation support, Managua, Nicaragua	2011

Technical Skills

Programming	Python, R, C++
Data & Statistics	Statistical analysis, visualization, ML
Geospatial	QGIS

Languages

English (native); Spanish (native); French (conversational)

Conferences and Workshops Attended

From Messy Documents to Structured Data: Practical Text Processing & Analysis for Social Science with Python	Feb 2026
R Package Development in Positron	Jan 2026
Advances in Complex Systems: Addressing the Zero-Emission Goal for Urban Well-Being, Como	Jul 2024
28th ICABR, Ravello, Italy	Jun 2024
Artificial Intelligence: A Practical Introduction Summer School, University of Warwick	Jul 2023
27th ICABR, Buenos Aires, Argentina	Jul 2023
Machine Learning Summer School, Department of Economics, University of Oxford	Sep 2022
26th ICABR, Bologna, Italy	Jul 2022
GIFS: Emerging Technologies for Global Food Security, Saskatoon, SK, Canada	Jun 2018
Grow Canada Conference, Calgary, AB, Canada	Nov 2017
UNICA Ethanol Summit, São Paulo, Brazil	Jul 2017

Presentations

Many academic presentations to peers and policy makers are available via my YouTube channel.

Published Papers

First-Author / Lead-Author Papers

- Macall, D. M., Durany, X. G., Villamayor-Tomas, S., & i Sànchez, D. R. (2026). A food system innovation: Vegetable production in rooftop greenhouses in Barcelona. *Cities*, 171, 106698.
- Macall, D. M., Durany, X. G., & Villamayor-Tomas, S. (2025). Agronomic and organizational aspects of Barcelona's community gardens. *Frontiers in Sustainable Food Systems*, 9, 1459265.
- Macall, D. M., Madrigal-Pana, J., Smyth, S. J., & Arias, A. G. (2023). Costa Rican consumer perceptions of gene-editing. *Heliyon*, 9(8).
- Macall, D. M., Kerr, W. A., & Smyth, S. J. (2022). Economic surplus implications of Mexico's decision to phaseout genetically modified maize imports. *GM Crops & Food*, 13(1), 388–401.
- Macall, D. M., Williams, C., Gleim, S., & Smyth, S. J. (2021). Canadian consumer opinions regarding food purchase decisions. *Journal of Agriculture and Food Research*, 3, 100098.
- Macall, D. M., Trabanino, C. R., Soto, A. H., & Smyth, S. J. (2020). Genetically modified maize impacts in Honduras: production and social issues. *Transgenic Research*, 29(5), 575–586.
- Macall, D. M., & Smyth, S. J. (2020). Ex-ante impact assessment of GM maize adoption in El Salvador. *GM Crops & Food*, 11(2), 70–78.

Co-Author Papers

- Smyth, S. J., Phillips, P. W., Macall, D. M., & Castle, D. (2024). Impacts of changes to Canada's Plant Breeders' Rights Act. *The Journal of World Intellectual Property*, 27(3), 397–409.
- Williams, C., Gleim, S., Smyth, S. J., & Macall, D. M. (2021). Canadian consumer risk perceptions of food production. *Journal of Agricultural & Food Information*, 22(3–4), 120–137.
- Sutherland, C., Macall, D., & Smyth, S. (2021). Canadian plant breeder opinions regarding changes to plant breeders rights. *Journal of Plant Breeding and Crop Science*, 13(2), 46–57.
- Lassoued, R., Macall, D. M., Smyth, S. J., Phillips, P. W., & Hessel, H. (2021). Data challenges for future plant gene editing: expert opinion. *Transgenic Research*, 30(6), 765–780.
- Lassoued, R., Phillips, P. W., Macall, D. M., Hessel, H., & Smyth, S. J. (2021). Expert opinions on the regulation of plant genome editing. *Plant Biotechnology Journal*, 19(6), 1104–1109.
- Lassoued, R., Macall, D. M., Smyth, S. J., Phillips, P. W., & Hessel, H. (2021). Expert insights on the impacts of, and potential for, agricultural big data. *Sustainability*, 13(5), 2521.
- Lassoued, R., Macall, D. M., Smyth, S. J., Phillips, P. W., & Hessel, H. (2020). How should we regulate products of new breeding techniques? Opinion of surveyed experts in plant biotechnology. *Biotechnology Reports*, 26, e00460.
- Smyth, S. J., Macall, D. M., Phillips, P. W., & de Beer, J. (2020). Implications of biological information digitization: Access and benefit sharing of plant genetic resources. *The Journal of World Intellectual Property*, 23(3–4), 267–287.

Lassoued, R., Macall, D. M., Smyth, S. J., Phillips, P. W., & Hessel, H. (2019). Risk and safety considerations of genome edited crops: expert opinion. *Current Research in Biotechnology*, 1, 11–21.

Lassoued, R., Macall, D. M., Hessel, H., Phillips, P. W., & Smyth, S. J. (2019). Benefits of genome-edited crops: expert opinion. *Transgenic Research*, 28(2), 247–256.

Working Papers and Work in Progress

”Effects of Climate Change on the Nutritional Quality Provide by the Vegetables Consumed in Spain.”

Academic

Stuart Smyth	Professor, Director, Agriculture Knowledge Mobilization Laboratory, University of Saskatchewan	stuart.smyth@usask.ca
Justus Wesseler	Prof. Dr., Agricultural Economics and Rural Policy, Wageningen University & Research	justus.wesseler@wur.nl
David Zilberman	Robinson Chair, Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics, UC Berkeley	zilber11@berkeley.edu

International Institutions

Hugo Chavarria	IICA Innovation and Bioeconomy Program Manager; Executive Secretary, LATAM Bioeconomy Network	hugo.chavarria@iica.int
Sara Savastano	Director, IFAD Research and Impact Assessment Division	s.savastano@ifad.org

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